

TOPIC 1: EFFECTIVE OFFICE PRACTICE

1. Definition of an Office

An office is a place where the administrative and clerical work of an organisation is carried out. It is the centre for planning, communication, record-keeping and coordination of business activities.

2. Types of Offices

- **Small office** – few staff, simple structure (e.g. a small shop's back office).
- **Large office** – many departments and staff (e.g. bank, ministry, big company).
- **Open-plan office** – shared space with few partitions.
- **Closed / cellular office** – separate rooms for individuals or small groups.
- **Virtual / home office** – work done remotely using technology.

3. Importance of an Office

- Centre of information and communication
- Keeps records and documents safely
- Supports decision-making and planning
- Coordinates the activities of the organisation
- Provides a place for dealing with customers and visitors

4. Summary

An office is the administrative hub of an organisation. Different types exist, but all support communication, records and coordination.

End of Topic 1